

NAVIGATOR KIDS: BRAVELY'S JUNGLE ADVENTURE

A Field Guide for Brave Explorers

WARNING: This book belongs to a Super-Sensor!

Explorer Name: _____

Date Mission Began: _____

My Super Powers (Check all that apply):

☐ I notice things other people miss.

☐ I have a super-fast brain.

☐ I feel feelings very deeply.

☐ I ask "Why?" a lot.

Page 2: The Story – The Watch Lion

Meet Bravely.

Bravely is a Lion Cub with a secret. He isn't just a regular lion; he is a **Super-Sensing Lion**. His ears can hear a twig snap from a mile away. His nose can smell rain before the clouds even arrive.

Because his senses are so super, his brain is always on high alert. Sometimes, his brain works so fast that it spots dangers that aren't even there!

When Bravely wants to try something new—like crossing the Monkey Bridge—his Super Brain screams: **"STOP! What if you fall? What if the monkeys laugh? What if it breaks?"**

So, Bravely freezes. He wants to go, but his paws feel stuck to the ground.

YOUR TURN:

Think of a time you felt like your paws were stuck. What was your brain saying? Draw or write the "Scary Thought" in the bubble below.

Page 3: Tool 1 – The Worry Shrink Ray

THE MISSION:

Your Super Brain is great at magnifying things. It makes small problems look HUGE. We need to use the **Worry Shrink Ray** to see how big the problem *really* is.

Step 1: The Monster Check

Think of a worry you have right now.

If 1 is a tiny ant and 10 is a giant T-Rex, how big does the worry **FEEL**?

(Color the bar)

[1][2][3][4][5][6][7][8][9][10]

Step 2: Zap It!

Ask yourself: *Is this dangerous (like a tiger)? Or just uncomfortable (like a mosquito)?*

Step 3: The Reality Check

How big is the worry **REALLY**?

(Color the bar again)

[1][2][3][4][5][6][7][8][9][10]

ZAP! You just shrank the monster!

Page 4: Tool 2 – The Ladder of Brave Steps

THE MISSION:

You don't have to jump to the top of the tree in one leap. That's impossible! Super Explorers use **Brave Baby Steps**.

Instructions:

Pick a goal (like "Going to a birthday party" or "Raising my hand in class"). Write it at the top. Then, break it down into tiny steps starting at the bottom.

MY GOAL: _____

Rung 4 (The Top!): I did it! _____

Rung 3 (Getting Closer): _____

Rung 2 (A Little Scary): _____

Rung 1 (Super Easy): _____

(Example: If you are scared of the pool, Rung 1 might just be "Looking at the water.")

Page 5: Tool 3 – The "What If" Flip Coin

THE MISSION:

Your brain loves to ask "What If?" But it usually only asks the scary version. We need to FLIP the coin to see the other side.

The "Heads" Side (The Worry):

"What if I make a mistake?"

"What if nobody talks to me?"

"What if I forget my lines?"

The "Tails" Side (The Flip):

To flip the coin, ask: **"What if it goes OKAY?"**

Your Turn to Flip:

Read the Worry, then write the Flip!

1. **Worry:** "What if I trip and fall?"

FLIP: _____

2. **Worry:** "What if the work is too hard?"

FLIP: _____

3. **Worry:** "What if they don't like my drawing?"

FLIP: _____

Page 6: The Science of Your Super Brain

Why Do We Worry?

Inside your brain, there are two important characters:

1. The Watch Dog (Amygdala)

The Watch Dog's job is to keep you safe. It barks when it sees danger! For kids with "Super Sensing" brains (like you!), the Watch Dog has super-hearing. Sometimes it barks at a math test the same way it would bark at a Bear!

2. The Wise Owl (Prefrontal Cortex)

The Owl is the boss. It makes plans and solves problems.

The Glitch:

When the Watch Dog barks too loud (ANXIETY!), the Wise Owl covers its ears and flies away. You can't think clearly because the Dog is barking!

How to Fix It:

When we use our tools (like the Shrink Ray or Deep Breaths), we pet the Watch Dog. We say, *"Thank you for protecting me, but it's just a math test, not a bear."* This calms the Dog down so the Wise Owl can come back and help you!

Page 7: Scenario Challenge

What Would You Do?

The Situation:

Bravely wants to join Karate class. He is standing at the door. His heart is beating fast (thump-thump-thump). His brain says: *"Everyone will look at you! You won't know the moves!"*

Choose Your Tool!

Which tool should Bravely use? (Circle one or more)

A) The Shrink Ray:

Ask: "Is a Karate class actually dangerous? No. It's just a class."

B) Brave Baby Steps:

Instead of joining the class today, Bravely will just sit on the bench and watch for 10 minutes.

C) The What If Flip:

Change *"What if I mess up?"* to *"What if I learn a cool kick?"*

What happens next?

If Bravely walks in the door, even if he is scared, he earns a **Bravery Badge**. Why?

Because Bravery isn't about *not* being scared. Bravery is being scared and DOING IT ANYWAY!

Page 8: Parent & Educator Guide

The Science Behind the Jungle

This workbook uses principles of **Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT)** and **Exposure Therapy**, adapted for neurodivergent (2e) minds.

1. Cognitive Defusion (The Shrink Ray):

Anxious children fuse with their thoughts—they believe their thoughts are facts. The Shrink Ray teaches them to observe the thought ("My brain is telling me this is big") rather than being the thought ("This is big"). This creates distance.

2. Graduated Exposure (Baby Steps):

Avoidance feeds anxiety. If a child avoids a stressor, their anxiety goes down immediately, but the long-term fear grows. We use "scaffolding" to break tasks down. The goal is to tolerate distress, not eliminate it immediately.

3. Cognitive Reframing (The Flip):

2e children often have vivid imaginations, which leads to catastrophic thinking. We don't want to invalidate their fear ("Don't worry"). Instead, we validate the possibility of a positive outcome. We replace "irrational fear" with "balanced thinking."

4. The "Effort" Mindset:

Gifted children often struggle with perfectionism. They fear trying if they can't be perfect immediately. We explicitly reward *trying* (The Bravery Badge) to separate their self-worth from the outcome.

Sidebar: When to step in?

- **Validate:** "I see your Watch Dog is barking really loud right now."
- **Support:** "Let's take one Baby Step together."
- **Release:** Let them try. It's okay if they are uncomfortable. That is how the brain learns resilience.

Page 9: Pocket Cards (Cut-Outs)



WORRY SHRINK RAY

1. Name the worry.
2. How big does it feel? (1-10)
3. How big is it REALLY?
Is it a Tiger (Danger) or a Mosquito (Annoying)?



BRAVE BABY STEPS

I don't have to do it all at once.

1. What is the tiny first step?
2. What is the next step?
Progress, not Perfection!



WHAT IF FLIP

My brain says:

"What if it goes wrong?"

I choose to ask:

"What if it goes RIGHT?"



BRAVERY BADGE

Definition of Bravery:

Being scared + Doing it anyway.

If I tried, I earned this badge!

OFFICIAL CERTIFICATE OF COURAGE

This certifies that

Has successfully learned the secrets of the Jungle and is now a certified

MASTER OF BRAVERY

You have proven that you can:

Shrink the Monsters 🗨️

Climb the Ladder 🦶

Flip the Thoughts ↺️

And Try New Things! 🏅

Signed: _____ (Parent/Guide)

Date: _____

"The roar is inside you!"